Flora Saenz

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Education

New Mexico State University —— GPA: 3.80 Las Cruces, NM
Bachelor of Arts in Creative Media, Minor in Digital Filmmaking *Obtained*

New Mexico State University —— GPA: 3.77 Las Cruces, NM
Master's in Computer Science *Projected End Date: December 2027*

Technical Skills

Languages: Java, Python C/C++, JavaScript, HTML/CSS, SQL
Frameworks: React, Node.js, TensorFlow, JUnit
Developer Tools: Git, Docker, VS Code, Visual Studio, Eclipse
Libraries: NumPy, TensorFlow

Projects

C-Algol Compiler | *C, Lex, Yacc, MIPS Assembly* August 2025 – December 2025

- Built a compiler for the C-Algol programming language, implementing lexical analysis, parsing, semantic checking, and code generation
- Created symbol tables and scope management systems to support variable declarations, functions, and nested scopes
- Generated optimized MIPS assembly code for arithmetic expressions, control flow statements, and function calls
- Developed an automated testing suite to verify compiler correctness across language rules.

Movie Tinder | *JavaScript, Node.js, React, TensorFlow, MongoDB* January 2026 – May 2026

- Built a full-stack movie discovery platform that uses a Tinder-style swipe interface and integrates with the TMDB API to surface movies based on genres, ratings, runtime, and user preferences.
- Developed a recommendation engine using TensorFlow that learns from user swipe behavior to generate personalized movie suggestions.
- Designed and implemented RESTful backend services with Node.js and MongoDB to manage user profiles and preference data.
- Created a responsive React frontend with real-time preference updates and dynamic recommendation generation

Experience

Graduate Teaching Assistant January 2026 – Present
Computer Science Department, New Mexico State University

- Assist undergraduate students with programming assignments focused on C++ and Java for an Object-Oriented Programming course and an Introduction to Data Structures course.
- Evaluate coursework and maintained grading consistency in collaboration with the course instructor.
- Hold weekly office hours to provide individualized academic support and improve student comprehension.
- Manage grade records and communicated timely feedback to students throughout the semester.

Graduate Advocate August 2026 – Present
Computing Alliance of Hispanic Serving Institutions

- Mentor and supervise undergraduate advocates across 4 different regions in the U.S.A.
- Provide timely feedback on workshop scheduling, planning, and logistics.
- Design and facilitate recreational activities that promote student engagement.
- Provide hands-on guidance during workshops and assist students with challenges in their STEM careers.

YWiC Summer Camp Assistant May 2026 – June 2026
Young Women in Computing, New Mexico State University

- Mentored and supervised middle school and high school students through a full-day STEM summer camp program.
- Adapted instructional activities and schedules in response to changing curriculum needs and classroom dynamics.
- Designed and facilitated recreational activities that promote student engagement.
- Provided hands-on guidance during workshops and assist students with challenges in STEM projects.

Student Peer Tutor August 2024 – January 2026
Academic Readiness Center, Dona Ana Community College

- Provided one-on-one tutoring in mathematics, English, Spanish, and digital media subjects.
- Adapted teaching strategies to accommodate diverse learning styles and improve student understanding.
- Facilitated student success workshops focused on study skills, academic planning, and course support.
- Produced and edited educational podcast content to expand access to campus resources and student guidance.
- Completed daily tutoring center maintenance operations to ensure an effective learning environment for students.